I think that that's the result of being on the road for years and growing a little selfish. I felt guilty when I wanted to play golf with my mates, whom I hadn't seen for a couple of months. I felt like I had to get Tenielle's permission. Then I'd really feel bad because I wasn't spending enough time with her. You know, here I am at home at last and the first thing I want to do is play golf with my mates or go on a boys' night out?

In a normal, healthy relationship you're supposed to want to be with your wife all the time. But we didn't have a normal relationship, and the problem lay with me … which I acknowledge. When we'd first moved in together, Tenielle didn't yet have a full-time job in Cape Town, so she obviously hung around the house quite a lot. When I had time off from cricket, I'd do my gym in the morning and then, if I wanted to see my mates in the afternoon, or play golf – and that takes, like, five or six hours – I'd have to cut things short because I needed to be home. Not that my mates gave me a hard time – I mean, quite a lot of them understood because they're married as well.

But I was also really excited about being with Tenielle. I wanted the house, the white picket fence, everything. And the funny thing is, I had the right woman. I always knew I had the right woman, and I really thought that I was ready to settle down. I grew comfortable with living in the same space as Tenielle during the years we shared a house. But then again, I wasn't home a helluva lot.

Of course it didn't help that I wasn't the most faithful boyfriend and husband. I didn't have sex with anyone else while I was married, but at that stage I was going balls to the wall with my drinking. And when you get drunk, your sense of responsibility diminishes. So, ja, I'd kiss the odd girl – nothing more than that – but then again, I'd get so hammered that I genuinely wouldn't know what I'd done.

Sometimes my mates would tell me what I had got up to the night before, and how can I put it? I'd be very surprised. So, ja, I kissed one or five girls during my marriage, but I don't remember most of what happened because I was *that* tanked. I'm not proud to admit it; it's just the way it was. I wasn't being totally unfaithful, but, still, my actions reflected where my head was.

Being in a steady relationship meant that I could never leave my phone on when Tenielle and I went to sleep. I always had to put it on silent, always, as I might have got the kind of text message that one's girlfriend definitely did not want to see. Even once I'd got engaged, I didn't tell any